Graphic Novel Presentation

*The End of the F*ing World & The Arrival*

[By: Andrew Ralph]

The End of the F*ing World

Title: The End of the F*ing World

Author: Charles Forsman

Written by: Charles Forsman

Illustrated by: Charles Forsman

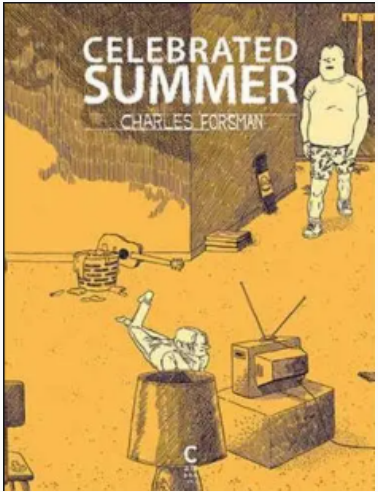
Published: 2013

Charles Forsman — Facts

- Founded Oily Comics in 2011 — an underground mini-comics press he ran himself
- His art is minimal and black-and-white. His characters are usually teenagers — isolated, impulsive, and capable of real violence.
- The book was adapted into a Channel 4 series in 2017, then picked up by Netflix in 2018

Other Works

- *Celebrated Summer* (2013) — Two teenagers drive around with nowhere to be
- *Revenger* (2012) — Someone gets wronged. They do something about it.



Genre & Audience

Genre

- Dark comedy
- Coming-of-age
- Psychological thriller

Intended Audience

- Mature teens and adults (17+)
- Readers who connect with uncomfortable characters

Content Warnings

- Violence/Murder and strong language
- Self-harm references

Story Breakdown

Setting: American suburbs. Rural roads, diners, motel rooms.

Characters: James, who has decided he is a psychopath. Alyssa, who does not care what anyone thinks.

Inciting Incident: James decides he wants to kill someone. He picks Alyssa.

Rising Action: They run. They break into empty houses and eat whatever is left in the cabinets. James had every intention of killing her. The longer they drive, the less certain he is about that.

Satisfactory End: James is shot. His last words are "I love you." Alyssa carves his name into her arm.

My Recommendation

My Rating

[9.7 / 10]

I would recommend this to...

Best read by someone who has already survived being a teenager. The alienation is specific enough to be funny in hindsight.

The Arrival

Title: The Arrival

Author: Shaun Tan

Written by: Shaun Tan

Illustrated by: Shaun Tan

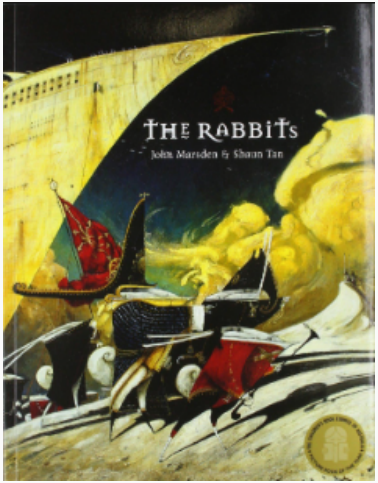
Published: 2006

Shaun Tan — Facts

- Australian author and illustrator. His worlds look like nothing else on the page.
- Won the Academy Award for Best Animated Short Film for *The Lost Thing* in 2011.
- Most of his work is about people who do not quite fit where they are.

Other Works

- *The Rabbits* (1998) — animals colonize a land. It does not go well for the ones already there.
- *Tales from Outer Suburbia* (2008) — short stories set in neighborhoods where something is slightly off.



Genre & Audience

Genre

- Wordless graphic novel
- Magical realism
- Immigration narrative

Intended Audience

- All ages — no words to get in the way
- Readers drawn to history, identity, and displacement

Content Warnings

- Themes of displacement and loss
- Allusions to war and persecution

Story Breakdown

Setting: A city with no name. Everything in it is slightly wrong in a way that makes sense.

Characters: A man. His wife and daughter, left at home.

Inciting Incident: He leaves. unbenknownst to the dangers ahead.

Rising Action: Nothing works the way he expects. Strangers help him. Though, they have their own stories.

Satisfactory End: He finds his own way. His family arrives to back him up.

My Recommendation

My Rating

[9 / 10]

I would recommend this to...

[This is a beautifuly shown graphic novel that leaves a good bit of the story up to user interpretation. I would recommend this to anyone interested in any kind of art or dark history books]